

Pamela Dale- Rourke

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PROFILE

Dedicated and innovative professional with a strong background in facilitating effective communication among children. I specialize in understanding and interpreting children's behavioral expressions, translating these into comprehensible messages. My experience encompasses working collaboratively with children, parents, and educators to create engaging resources that enhance communication and learning. I am adept at developing visually appealing materials that support children's emotional and social well-being, and I bring a wealth of transferable skills related to therapeutic practices, ensuring successful outcomes for young people in diverse settings. My personal connection to AAC through supporting family members enriches my perspective on inclusive communication strategies.

EDUCATION

BSc | University of Central Lancashire

SKILLS

- Strong digital skills for resource creation
- layout
- and design.
- Understanding of inclusive communication
- SEN
- and speech and language therapy.
- Collaboration with therapists
- educators
- and families to ensure resources meet user needs.
- Mind Express 5
- Widgit Online).
- Knowledge of AAC symbol systems (PCS
- SymbolStix
- Widgit
- Bliss

HOBBIES



Travel



Reading



Photography



Music



Swimming



Fitness



Writing



Meditation



Art

CERTIFICATIONS

- DDP (Diadic Developmental Psychotherapy) Health & Social Care (Preston College)
- Play Therapy (Canterbury Christ University)
- Filial Therapy in Family Therapy (Manchester)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Service Lead for Schools | Child in Mind, Manchester | October 2016 - Present

- Designed and tailored communication and therapeutic resources to empower children in educational settings, utilizing visual supports and symbol-based activities to facilitate understanding.
- Provided impactful 1:1 Play Therapy and Family Therapy, focusing on psychotherapeutic assessments that guide tailored therapeutic pathways for children.
- Collaborated closely with educators and therapists to develop accessible and engaging materials for children with a range of communication and learning needs.
- Supervised and mentored postgraduate Play Therapy students, delivering training on effective resource utilization and inclusive communication strategies.
- Implemented workshops for teachers on child-centered communication techniques, fostering a supportive environment for children's emotional and psychological growth.
- Conducted regular evaluations of therapy programs, ensuring continuous improvement and alignment with children's evolving needs.

Play Therapist | Barnardos, St Helens | January 2015 - October 2016

- Developed individualized visual and therapeutic resources tailored for children referred through CAMHS, enhancing their communication capabilities.
- Participated actively in assessment meetings, providing insights and recommendations for appropriate communication supports tailored to each referral's needs.
- Managed a diverse caseload of school-aged children, implementing creative and resource-based interventions to address a wide spectrum of social, emotional, and communication challenges.
- Facilitated group supervision sessions focused on best practices in child-centered communication strategies, promoting team knowledge and skill enhancement.
- Engaged with families to ensure therapeutic interventions were aligned with their expectations and cultural values, fostering trust and collaboration.

Family Session Worker | OJs, Preston | May 2023 - January 2024

- Supported families of children on the autism spectrum by creating and adapting inclusive resources that enhanced engagement and communication.
- Developed practical activities aimed at ensuring meaningful participation of children with communication differences in group settings, promoting social interaction and learning.
- Collaborated with families and interdisciplinary teams to address specific needs, ensuring resources were user-friendly and effective.
- Facilitated family workshops to educate and empower parents in supporting their children's communication and social skills development.
- Monitored progress and provided feedback to families about their children's engagement, ensuring a responsive approach to each child's unique requirements.

Plan and Resource Creator | International school | Not Specified

- Planned and developed engaging literacy and learning resources tailored for primary-aged children, ensuring alignment with developmental milestones.
- Created dynamic classroom materials designed to support reading and writing development, facilitating an engaging learning environment.
- Worked collaboratively with educators to align resources with lesson objectives, enhancing overall educational delivery.
- Adapted activities to accommodate varying learning needs and levels, ensuring an inclusive approach to education.
- Conducted feedback sessions with teachers to refine resources based on classroom experiences and children's responses.